



AFTER

In the second half of 1864, while generals Grant and Lee were locked in the Richmond-Petersburg lines, events elsewhere were turning the tide for the Union.

A ROUND OF UNION VICTORIES

Union successes continued until late in the year. In December 1864, General George H. Thomas destroyed the remnants of the Confederate Army of Tennessee at [Franklin and Nashville](#). General William T. Sherman captured not just Atlanta, but Savannah as well, at Christmas. This set the stage for him to **lead his victorious troops to the state where the war had started: South Carolina** (see [The Carolinas and Alabama](#)). The destruction of the capital, Columbia, was another example of total war.

THE ROAD TO APPOMATTOX

The Petersburg stalemate continued until April 1865, when Grant, having outdug and outgunned Lee, **finally shattered the Confederate right flank** (see [The Fall of Petersburg and Richmond](#)). This forced the beleaguered Army of Northern Virginia out of its entrenchments and onto [the road to Appomattox](#).